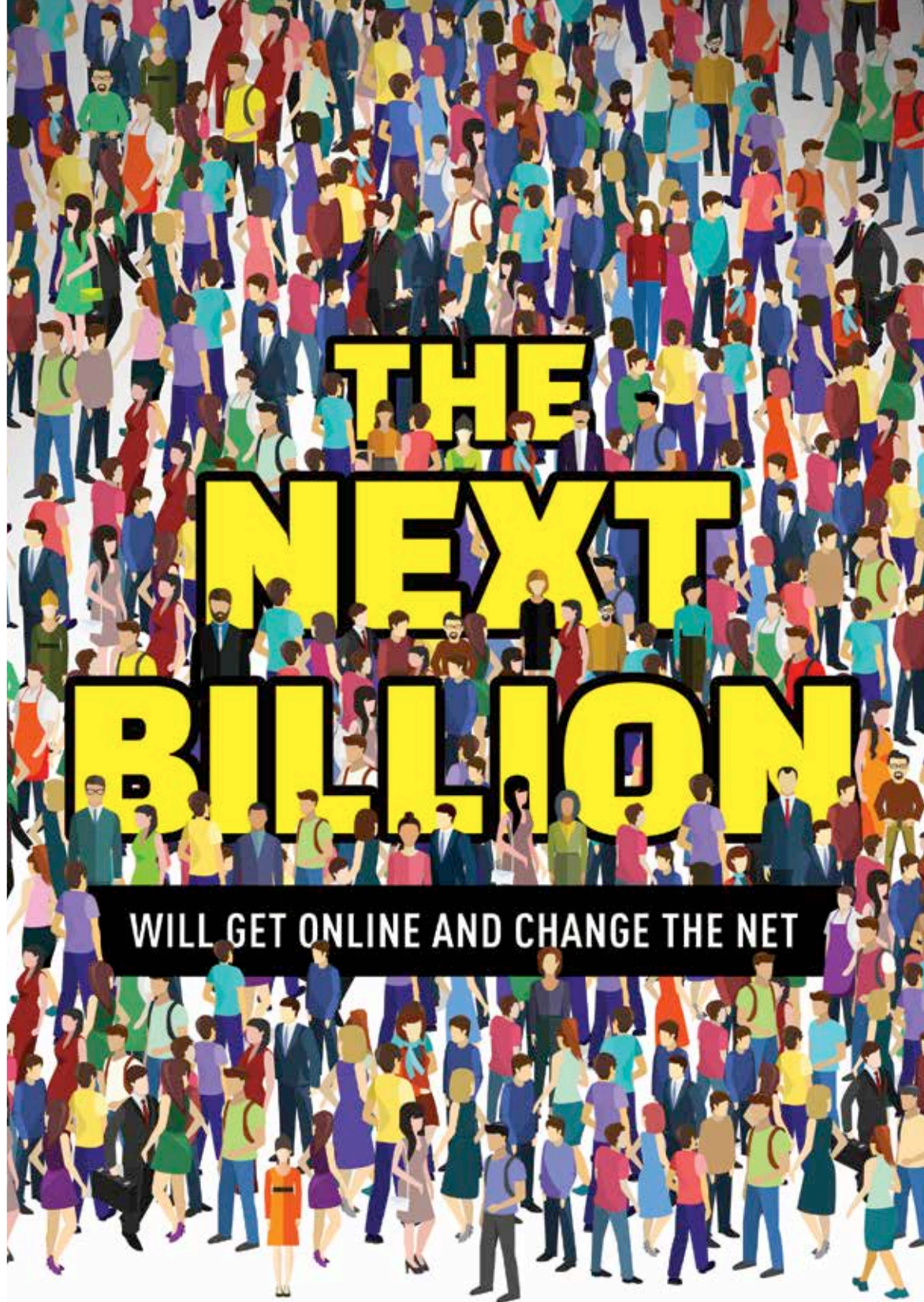




THE NEXT BILLION

WILL GET ONLINE AND CHANGE THE NET

Imaging: Anil VK

Look, this is just a catchphrase, a buzzword that companies, such as Google, are using to talk about the people who are yet to come online and start using the Internet fully. Approximately half the world is online in some form or the other, and the other half is yet to get access. Apart from really old

people who feel no use for, or just cannot use the Internet, globally, not being on the Internet boils down to questions of availability, affordability and relevance. In this cover story, we look at the next billion, many of whom reside in our country, and see how this will change the way the net works, and how we use it.